



STATUS REPORT

Eritrea: status report

Edition of 2026-09-02 · 40 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-09-01 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/ERI/Ledger.csv](#) (40 systems and instruments, 15 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

SUMMARY OF POSITION · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · GAPS TO FILL

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Eritrea's digitally-tracked state consists of a small number of discrete projects rather than a connected system: a customs platform delivered with UNDP support in January 2026 ([ASYCUDA World](#)), a completed national household survey using digital data collection ([EPHS 2025](#)), and a domestically built offline AI application ([Eri-Chat](#)). No foundational digital-ID system, mobile-money service or data-protection law is held on record. Connectivity is among the lowest recorded on the continent — [23.7% of the population held a mobile connection in late 2025](#) — and the state telecom monopoly EriTel reports no submarine cable landing and, as of July 2026, [no announced Starlink launch date](#). A July 2026 legal notice ordering all cash deposited into banks by 31 July or "face legal action" is the period's most consequential governance development, issued against a cash-based, under-banked economy. The evidence base itself is unusually constrained: the outlets producing dated material are limited to Eritrea's Ministry of Information (Shabait) and the diaspora/opposition outlet Awate.com, neither neutral, with harder figures coming from UNDP/UNECA and reference indices.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domesticated geospatial information framework action plan	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Action plan produced 2026-04-06

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Bank of Eritrea cash-deposit legal notice	ENACTED, DEPOSIT DEADLINE 2026-07-31 ↗	Legal notice issued (~30 Jun 2026) ordering cash held outside banks deposited by 31 Jul 2026 or face legal action
Computer-offence provisions of the 2015 Penal Code	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Penal Code enacted 2015-05-15
Nationality Proclamation 21/1992	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force since 1992-04-06
Artificial intelligence law and strategy	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – A JUNE 2026 LEGAL-STATUS REVIEW FOUND NO AI LAW, NO NATIONAL STRATEGY AND NO INSTITUTION WITH A MANDATE	Reviewed 2026-06-08
Electronic transactions and e-commerce framework	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – NO ELECTRONIC TRANSACTIONS FRAMEWORK IN FORCE; THE ONLY TEXTS LOCATED ARE UNOFFICIAL CONSULTATION DRAFTS	Drafts published 2026-01
Freedom of information law	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – A UN REVIEW CONTRIBUTION STATES PLAINLY THAT NO FREEDOM OF INFORMATION LAW HAS BEEN ADOPTED	Reviewed 2026-01
Statistics law	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – A DRAFT STATISTICAL PROCLAMATION WAS RECORDED PENDING IN 2007 AND NO LATER ENACTMENT WAS LOCATED	Draft recorded pending 2007-01-08

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data-protection law	NOT HELD	Redetermined 2026-08-01

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Regional shared digital infrastructure	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE PLANNING TREATS ERITREA AS A GAP TO BE CLOSED RATHER THAN A CONNECTED PARTICIPANT	Master plan published 2020-03-06

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Eritrean Standards Institution	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established 1995-09-20

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Non-governmental contribution to national policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Workshops held 2026-07
Public discussion of government policy	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – NO INDEPENDENT PRESS, PERMITTED CIVIL SOCIETY OR PUBLIC FORUM IN WHICH POLICY COULD BE ARGUED	Commission reported 2015-06-05

The one governance development on record is a [Bank of Eritrea legal notice](#), issued around 30 June 2026 and reported by the diaspora/opposition outlet Awate.com with the notice's own text embedded, ordering individuals and institutions to deposit cash held outside banks by 31 July 2026 "or face legal action." The notice defines neither an "excessive amount" nor an enforcement mechanism. No data-protection law, bill or regulator designation is held on record.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
African Development Bank financial-sector modernisation dialogue	PLANNED ↗	Mission held 2026-04

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
UNDP 'Economic & Social Data Development Eritrea' grant (IATI 00099544)	IN DEVELOPMENT, ACTIVE (PER IATI RECORD) ↗	UNDP commits US\$1,676,837 grant to the Government of Eritrea / National Statistics Office

The only tracked non-state finance record is a [US\\$1,676,837 UNDP grant](#) to the National Statistics Office, committed in 2019 with an end year of 2026, funding the statistical-capacity building that produced EPHS 2025. The wiki's domestic-state budget layer is not currently populated for Eritrea.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EriTel national network expansion programme	IMPLEMENTED, ONGOING EXPANSION ↗	Minister reports 184 towers installed, ~90% geographic mobile coverage, service 'reaching 4G level' (government claim)
Starlink satellite internet service	NOT HELD	Starlink's own coverage-availability map lists Eritrea 'No planned launch date'
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	NOT HELD	Cable industry calls Eritrea a 'black hole' that does not answer landing requests; still cable-less as of Apr 2026

Eritrea's international connectivity runs entirely on satellite. The country holds no submarine fibre-optic cable landing, and cable firms describe the government as unresponsive even to a Red Sea route sought after Houthi attacks made Yemeni waters unusable — a position unchanged as of April 2026 and one that leaves Eritrea, on the

industry's own undated count, as the sole non-landing state among Africa's 38 coastal countries. [Starlink](#), available in half of Africa's sovereign states by July 2026, carries no announced launch date for Eritrea, one of only seven African states — all in the north or the Horn — in that position; no licence application or refusal has been found. Domestically, the state telecom monopoly EriTel [reports 184 towers installed and roughly 90% geographic mobile coverage as of May 2026](#), alongside international bandwidth risen to about 1,536 Mbps over the preceding decade — figures from the responsible minister that cannot be independently verified.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ASYCUDA World customs platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated 2026-01-08, replacing 2007-era customs software
Vulnerability database for social protection	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established, reported 2023-04

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National foundational digital ID	NOT HELD, PROFILED 2025-07-26	Global Digital Identity Index profile finds no operational foundational ID; sets out the barriers a future system would face

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Mobile money / digital payments service	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 — A REGIONAL PEER ASSESSMENT RECORDS A STATE-OWNED FINANCIAL SYSTEM WITH NO CASH MACHINES, CARDS OR INTERNET BANKING	Peer assessment adopted 2025-07

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Business Information Register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established 2002-12-27
Cadastral Office and land register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established 1997-05-19
Zoba-level digital population registers	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Registers in place since 2001
National address and postcode system	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 — ERITREA DOES NOT APPEAR ON THE POSTAL UNION'S LIST OF COUNTRIES OPERATING A POSTCODE SYSTEM	Reference list dated 2026-08
Voter register	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 — THE ELECTORAL LAW PROVIDES FOR A REGISTER BUT NO NATIONAL ELECTION HAS BEEN HELD UNDER IT	Law provides for a register

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Education and teacher management information systems	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Delegation attended 2025-06
National Health Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Sequencing applied 2026-07-17

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Online government services	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – THE CUSTOMS PLATFORM IS THE ONLY OPERATING GOVERNMENT DIGITAL SYSTEM ON THE BASE AND IT IS INTERNAL, NOT CITIZEN-FACING	Customs platform inaugurated 2026-01

The clearest concrete step in the period is the [January 2026 launch of ASYCUDA World](#), UNCTAD's automated customs platform, replacing software in use since 2007; the deployment came with a full transfer of source code to the Eritrean government, a national-ownership condition rather than a licensed or hosted arrangement. Statistical infrastructure has also advanced: [the National Statistics Office completed the Fourth Round Population and Health Survey in 2025](#), covering 9,794 households across all six regions using tablet-based interviewing rather than paper forms, with the full report due in 2026 under a UNDP/UNECA-backed programme that has funded Eritrean statistical-capacity building since at least 2019. No foundational digital-identity system is held on record — [an analytical profile finds the country lacks one](#) and sets out what a future system would have to overcome — and no mobile-money or digital-payments service is held either, consistent with the cash-based, under-banked economy discussed under Governance below.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ICT at sub-national government offices	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Assessed 2002-07-08

The base holds no digitalisation rows for Eritrea. What little it carries of public digital service sits under DPI, and the absence here is a statement about the record.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Agricultural expert system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Division established 2019
Eri-Chat offline AI app	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Q&A profile of developer Naod Goitom Isaac; app launched April 2025, showcased at Asmara UN Day event, Oct 2025

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Control of artificial-intelligence abuse	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31 – NO DOMESTIC LAW, REGULATOR OR TAKEDOWN ROUTE EXISTS; THE ONLY RESPONSE ON THE RECORD IS EXTERNAL FACT-CHECKING	Fact-check published 2026-04-02

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Shambko Apps Group Tigrinya-language applications	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Five applications released, described in a 2026-08-15 interview
Youth Innovation and Entrepreneurship Hub	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established 2023

The base holds one concrete AI/innovation data point: [Eri-Chat](#), an offline artificial-intelligence mobile application built by a Ministry of Information software developer and launched in April 2025, storing conversation data only on the user's device. It was showcased to ambassadors and UN officials at Asmara's UN Day event in October 2025; it remains English-only, its developer citing insufficient training data for Eritrea's other languages.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital training for government employees	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Training reported 2025-11-01

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Mai Nefhi College of Engineering and Technology	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Engineering day held 2026-05-07

The base holds no capacity rows for Eritrea: no training programme, research centre mandate or published output under this heading.

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EriTel internet complaint form	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live at the probe date

No dedicated inclusion or capacity-building instrument is held for Eritrea. The only inclusion-relevant record is the mobile-connectivity trend carried under Infrastructure above; its movement over the past twelve months is set out in the progress report.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Fourth Round Eritrea Population and Health Survey (EPHS 2025)	IMPLEMENTED, COMPLETED; REPORT PENDING 2026 ↗	NSO reports survey completion: 9,794 households, 405 enumeration areas, 98.4% household completion, CAPI digital collection

Statistics is the one part of Eritrea's record with delivery behind it: the [Fourth Round Eritrea Population and Health Survey](#) has been completed, with its report pending in 2026. The base holds no open-data portal or publication schedule beyond it.

Geopolitics

The base holds no geopolitics rows for Eritrea. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

The base holds no geopolitics rows for Eritrea. No bilateral digital cooperation instrument with any partner is on file.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National foundational digital ID	A named programme, pilot or vendor engagement for a foundational digital-ID system distinct from the passport/civil-registration base already on file.	not yet probed
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	A licensing decision, application, or a dated update to the Submarine Networks registry's coastal-state count.	not yet probed
Starlink satellite internet service	A licence application, refusal, or an updated Starlink coverage-map entry for Eritrea.	not yet probed
Mobile money / digital payments service	A named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot, or a central-bank statement on digital payments distinct from the cash-deposit ultimatum.	not yet probed
Data-protection law	A published data-protection bill, statute or regulator designation.	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence law and strategy	A published national AI strategy or draft, or any statute or regulation addressed to artificial intelligence.	2026-08-31
Electronic transactions and e-commerce framework	A proclamation, regulation or gazetted bill giving legal effect to electronic signatures, records or contracts.	2026-08-31
Freedom of information law	An adopted freedom of information or access to information proclamation, with a request procedure and an appeal route.	2026-08-31
Statistics law	An enacted statistical proclamation giving the national statistics office a statutory mandate.	2026-08-31
Public discussion of government policy	An independent publication, permitted civil-society body or public forum in which digital or data policy is argued.	2026-08-31
National address and postcode system	A national postcode or street-addressing scheme, or a government statement that one is being built.	2026-08-31
Voter register	A voter register compiled under the electoral law, or an electoral commission constituted to prepare one.	2026-08-31
Online government services	Any citizen-facing online government service — an application, payment, licence or record request completed online.	2026-08-31
Regional shared digital infrastructure	A signed interconnection, cable landing or regional infrastructure agreement naming Eritrea as a participant.	2026-08-31
Control of artificial-intelligence abuse	A domestic law, regulator, platform agreement or takedown route addressed to synthetic or manipulated media.	2026-08-31

The table above sets out what would settle each of the absences noted through this document: a named digital-ID programme, a cable-landing decision, a Starlink licensing outcome, a named mobile-money service, and a published data-protection instrument.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.